

COUCH · TRYCOUCH.APP

Practice therapy **before it counts.**

Virtual patients for therapists in training. Low-stakes reps
for high-stakes work.

Prepared for Eric Simons · July 2026 · this deck is a working web app, built with Bolt Slides

YEARS OF THEORY. THEN A REAL HUMAN.

1

role-playing exercise in an entire psychology degree.

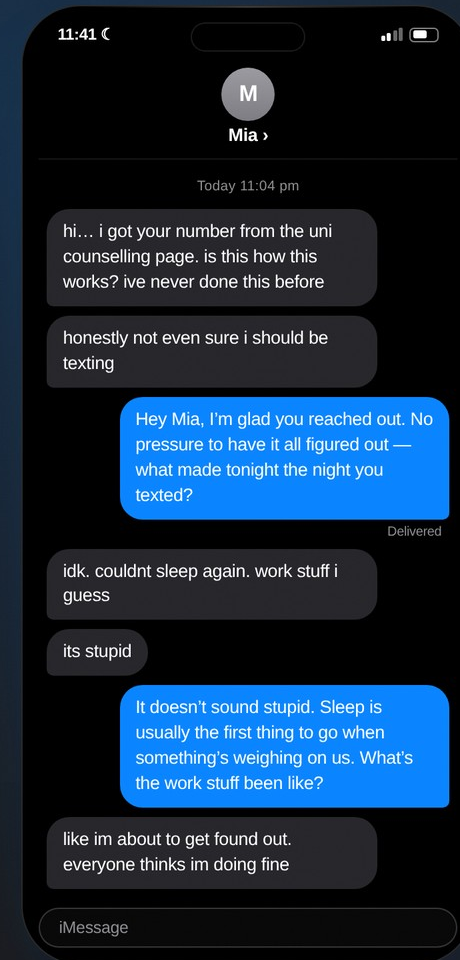
The top-voted complaint in the student community — real post, 54 upvotes · “I’m paying \$60k for this degree. I shouldn’t be teaching myself.”

MEET MIA

A patient in your pocket **you can't hurt.**

Mia texts like a real first-time client: lowercase, guarded, sometimes hours between replies. Rush to fix her and she cools off. Show real skill and she opens up. She's winnable, not automatic.

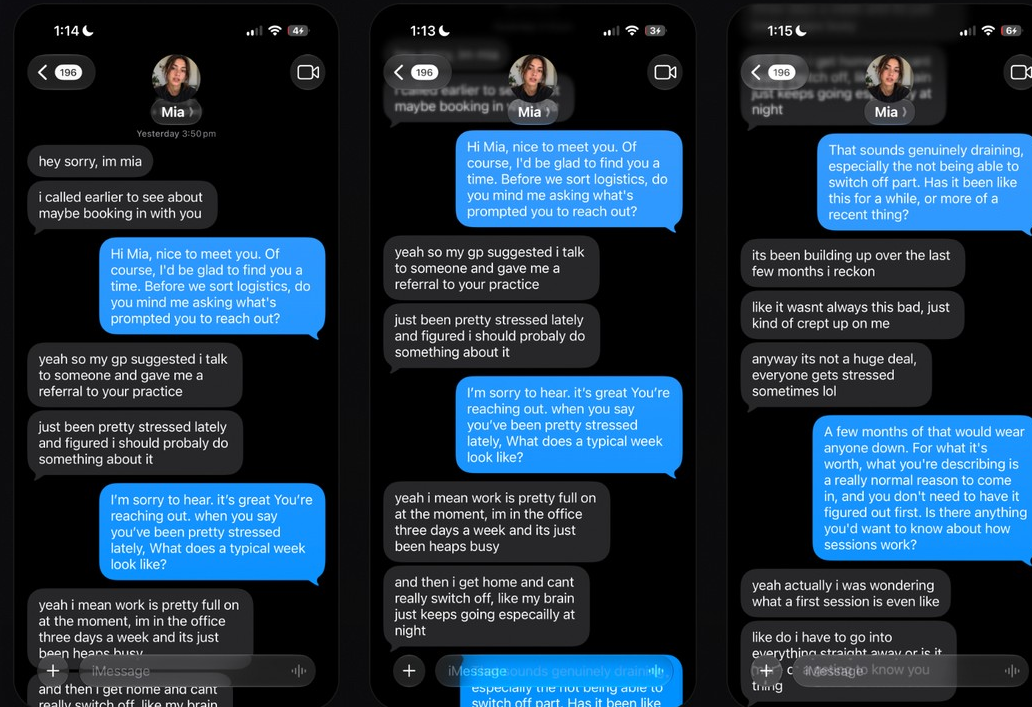
advance (→) to play the session



RECEIPTS

Not a mockup.

Live on iMessage today. Note the clock.



Unedited screenshots from the current build · July 2026

Session debrief

Mia · 14 min · text

3 STRENGTHS

- ✓ Validated before problem-solving
- ✓ One open question did the heavy lifting
- ✓ Matched her pace — no rush to fix

3 NEXT MOVES

- Reflect the feeling, not just the facts
- Name the sleep pattern earlier
- Sit longer in the silence after "its stupid"

1 MICRO-DRILL

Respond to "its stupid" three ways — without reassuring her once.

THE LOOP

Every rep ends in a debrief.

Sessions run under 20 minutes; some are 6 or 7. Each one closes with three strengths, three next moves, and one micro-drill. Reps with specific feedback is how the skill actually builds.

REALISM IS ENGINEERED, NOT PROMPTED

Students already practise on ChatGPT. It can't play the part.

A PROMPTED LLM

“The world’s most pleasant client”

- × Agreeable on contact — resistance folds in one turn
- × Over-discloses, in textbook language
- × “Solved” in three turns

MIA

Winnable, not automatic

- ✓ Guarded, gradual disclosure that responds to technique
- ✓ A believable texting register — cadence, typos, hours-later replies
- ✓ Booking and safety handoffs on deterministic logic, never model phrasing



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THE EVIDENCE

Text-first is the recommended entry point, not a compromise.

PATIENT-Ψ · EMNLP 2024

Trainees who practised with simulated patients gained skill and confidence beyond textbooks, videos, and peer role-play.

COUNSELLOR-TRAINEE STUDY · 2025

Recommends text-based simulation as the starting modality for clinical practice — the pocket-sized rep comes first.

The debrief engine is built to generate the same evidence from our own usage.

THE REAL COMPETITOR IS THE STATUS QUO

What a rep costs today.

	Couch	Role-play & actor patients	ChatGPT
Cost per rep	cents	\$50–100+ an hour	free
There at 11pm	✓	✗	✓
Resists like a real client	✓	✓	✗
Private — no peer audience	✓	✗	✓
Debrief after every rep	✓	✗	✗
Booked in seconds, not weeks	✓	✗	✓

THE WEDGE

Melbourne first. Then APAC.

Distribution is 1:1 through psych societies, supervisors and word of mouth. Own one dense city, then widen through the same channels.

psych students in Melbourne · 9 universities **8,000+**

psychology students across APAC **65–80k**

is enough to prove the wedge **1 city**



HOW IT MAKES MONEY

Students are the wedge. The institution is the buyer that persists.

01

Students subscribe

A\$15–25 a month for private, high-frequency reps. Usage peaks across the 4–7 training years, then ends at licensure — by design.

02

Universities license cohorts

A voluntary, formative practice layer for a whole intake. Students graduate; the institution persists.

03

Professions expand

Social work, nursing, medical communication — the same theory-to-practice gap. Simulation is already a line item in health-education budgets.

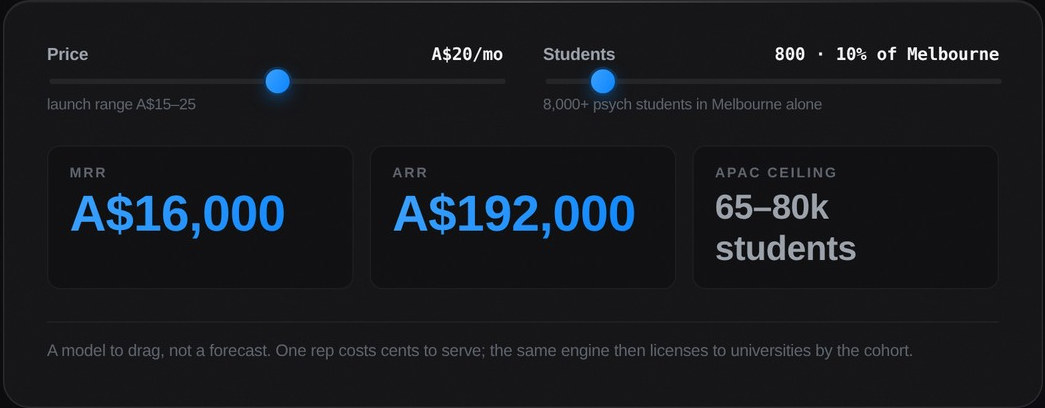


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DRAG IT YOURSELF

Run the Melbourne wedge.



TRACTION · JULY 2026

What exists today.

—
5

**students in closed
alpha**

psychology & counselling,
Melbourne

—
3

**universities in
curriculum talks**

Melbourne, Deakin & Monash

—
\$0

raised

solo-built end to end

—
Built

voice & video sessions

in testing — same patient engine
as text



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WHY ME

Second clinical product. Same solo founder.

MEDREPORT · PRODUCT #1

8

practices paying \$299/mo

Documentation for Australian psychology practices. Shipped solo, now maintenance mode — it pays the bills while Couch is built.

THE INSIGHT

Two years inside those practices

Watching graduates arrive visibly short on practice. Couch is that gap, productised.

BEFORE SOFTWARE · MANGO CLUB

1,500–3,000 people every Friday, for two years

Co-founded at 21. Zero paid ads in year one — a 200+ promoter street team. Distribution is muscle memory.

THE BUILD

Self-taught. Ships alone.

Early Couch prototypes built in Bolt. This deck is Bolt Slides.

TIMING

Why now, specifically.

Models can finally hold a patient who resists, remembers, and responds to technique. The validating research only landed in late 2024 and 2025.

Australia's psychology-education pathway is being redesigned right now. The training window itself is in play.

SimCare AI went institutional with live avatars. Theravue sells skills modules. Nobody owns the texting patient in the student's pocket.

THE ASK

\$50k.

First money in. It converts the Melbourne wedge: closed alpha to paid launch, a first university pilot, voice sessions out of testing.

One founder, no office, product #1 still paying the bills. The money buys runway and experiments, not headcount.

Bolt closed the gap between wanting to build and building.

Couch closes the gap between studying therapy and practising it.

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press A to annotate — it's your engine · press G for the whole deck